

CAPITAL MARKETS

Can a Golf Resort Sale Prove Time Is the Most Expensive Ingredient in CRE?

Centaur's \$191M exit shows how execution timelines and capital costs shape who profits in master-planned development.

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A source-grounded Light Tower Insight. The complete note follows.

Ohana Real Estate Investors paid \$191.2 million for Panther National, a golf resort and housing development in Palm Beach Gardens. J.P. Morgan Chase supplied a \$115 million acquisition loan. The headline is a sale. The story is about time.

Centaur Holdings bought the land for \$60 million in 2021. It completed the golf course in 2023. It secured a \$160 million debt package in 2024 to refinance and build homes and a clubhouse. Now it has sold the entire project for \$191 million. The math looks straightforward. The timeline tells a different story.

Centaur did not fail. It executed. It bought raw land, built a Nicklaus-Thomas course, added infrastructure, and delivered a finished resort with 68 homes and plans for 150 more. But the five-year hold from 2021 to 2026 spanned a period when construction costs surged, interest rates rose, and the capital markets for development debt tightened. The \$160 million debt package from Southern Realty Trust and Sunrise Realty Trust in 2024 was not a sign of abundance. It was a sign that Centaur needed to refinance an existing note and fund the remaining build-out at a time when bank construction lending had already pulled back.

The \$115 million acquisition loan from J.P. Morgan is the most revealing number in the deal. It is not a construction loan. It is a permanent loan on a stabilized asset. J.P. Morgan is underwriting the resort as a going concern, not a development project. That means Ohana is buying a completed product with an operating history, not a vision. The lender is betting on cash flow from the golf course, the clubhouse, and the existing homes, not on the developer's ability to deliver the remaining 150 lots.

Centaur's exit price of \$191 million, against a land cost of \$60 million and a subsequent \$160 million debt package, implies a relatively thin equity return for the risk taken. The developer carried the execution risk through the highest-cost period for construction and financing in a decade. The buyer, Ohana, is stepping into a stabilized asset with a lower cost of capital and a longer time horizon. The seller absorbed the timeline risk. The buyer is buying the cash flow.

This is the pattern that matters. In a rising rate environment, the developer who holds through construction and lease-up bears the cost of time. The buyer who acquires after stabilization captures

the benefit of that elapsed time without having lived through it. The capital stack reflects this: the construction lender charges a premium for the uncertainty of the build; the permanent lender charges a lower rate for the certainty of the operating asset. The spread between those two costs is the price of time.

For owners and sponsors with maturing construction loans or unfinished developments, the implication is direct. The window to sell before stabilization is narrowing. Buyers like Ohana are willing to pay for completed assets, but they are not paying for the developer's sunk timeline. They are paying for the basis that makes sense today, not the basis that made sense when the land was bought. Centaur's \$60 million land cost in 2021 was a bet on a lower-rate, lower-cost future. The \$191 million sale price in 2026 is the market's verdict on that bet.

For lenders, the deal tests whether the permanent market is willing to refinance development debt at scale. J.P. Morgan's \$115 million loan suggests the answer is yes, but only for assets that are truly stabilized and located in a strong demand market like Palm Beach Gardens. The 150 remaining homes that Ohana plans to build will require additional capital. That capital will come at today's rates, not 2021's rates. The buyer's underwriting will need to pencil at current construction costs and current absorption pace.

The broader market signal is about who bears the cost of time. In a cycle where rates stay higher for longer, the developer who holds through the build-out is the one who absorbs the rate shock. The buyer who acquires after stabilization is the one who benefits from the rate decline that may or may not come. The sale of Panther National is not a victory lap for Centaur. It is a controlled exit from a position that became more expensive to carry than the developer anticipated.

The next test is whether the remaining 150 homes get built, and at what price. If Ohana can deliver them at a cost that generates a return above its cost of capital, the deal will look like a smart acquisition. If construction costs or absorption slow, the buyer will discover that time is not done extracting its price.

SOURCES

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<https://commercialobserver.com/2026/07/centaur-panther-national-avenir-ohana-palm-beach-gardens/>

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